

Guidelines for Identifying Narrative Spans

1. Task Description

- Read interview excerpts and mark the points where the interviewee begins and ends any of three types of narratives within the interview: a **story**, a **habitual narrative**, or a **hypothetical narrative** (see definitions below for each).

Supplementary notes:

- In the row where a story, habitual narrative, or hypothetical narrative **starts**, mark the corresponding column with “**S**.” In the row where that narrative **ends**, mark the column with “**E**.” For each S–E pair, the interval from S to E will automatically be highlighted (see the [template](#)).
- At the end of the annotation task, please check that there are no uncolored “S” or “E” marks remaining.

2. Annotation Example

Below is an example of how to mark the beginning and end of narrative spans within interview clauses. The columns show the interview ID, topic, clause ID, speaker, clause content, and whether a story, habitual narrative, or hypothetical narrative begins (“S”) or ends (“E”) at that clause.

index	interview ID	topic	clause ID	speaker	clause	Story	Habitual	Hypothetical
1	P01	Problems	1	Interviewer	Do you have any problems?			
2	P01	Problems	2	Interviewee	Do I have any problems?			

3	P01	Problems	3	Interviewee	Let me see.
4	P01	Problems	4	Interviewee	We enjoy traveling abroad.
5	P01	Problems	5	Interviewee	We used to go quite often.
6	P01	Problems	6	Interviewee	In the past, my husband would research local information in advance.
7	P01	Problems	7	Interviewee	He even memorized the map perfectly.
8	P01	Problems	8	Interviewee	On site, he would take the lead and show us around.
9	P01	Problems	9	Interviewee	This summer, when we went on a trip to China,

S

S

E

10	P01	Problems	10	Interviewee	my husband said he was going to the restroom
11	P01	Problems	11	Interviewee	and went off to look for it,
12	P01	Problems	12	Interviewee	but he got lost.
13	P01	Problems	13	Interviewee	I had given him a cell phone,
14	P01	Problems	14	Interviewee	so if he had used it to contact us,
15	P01	Problems	15	Interviewee	we could have met up quickly
16	P01	Problems	16	Interviewee	and then gone to see a play afterward.
17	P01	Problems	17	Interviewee	Apparently he didn't think of that either,
18	P01	Problems	18	Interviewee	so we searched for two hours

S

E

19	P01	Problems	19	Interviewee	and finally found him.
20	P01	Problems	20	Interviewee	At that time, I scolded him, saying, "Why didn't you call?"
21	P01	Problems	21	Interviewee	Now that I think about it, dementia may already have been a factor.

E

3. Definitions of Stories, Habitual Narratives, and Hypothetical Narratives

Below are definitions for each narrative type (see the annotation example above for specific instances).

- **Story** – A narrative consisting of **two or more clauses** that recalls a sequence of events that occurred once at a specific point in the past.
- **Habitual narrative** – A narrative consisting of **two or more clauses** about habitual actions, daily routines, or recurring events in the past, focusing on a single cycle of repetition.
- **Hypothetical narrative** – A narrative consisting of **two or more clauses** describing events or actions that did not actually happen.
- **Other** – Responses to the interviewer, back-channel remarks, and any other parts of the interview that do not fit into any of the three narrative categories above. Even if some form of "narration" is present, it should be classified as "Other" if it does not meet the definitions above.

4. Criteria for Determining the Start and End of Stories and Narratives

4.1 Criteria Based on the Presence of an Overview/Introduction and the Main Event, Habit, or Hypothetical Situation

- **Story**

- A story is a narrative that recalls a sequence of events.
- To begin speaking about the past, the narrator introduces the circumstances under which the sequence occurred or gives an overview of the story that follows. **Consider the story as starting from this overview or introduction.**
- As long as the narrator continues to comment on **the same sequence of events**, consider it to be one continuous story.
- Conversely, even if the interviewee's speech is relatively continuous and the interviewer's interventions are minimal, if **the conversation shifts to a different series of events**, determine that the first story has ended and a new story has begun.
 - In order to show that a different series of events is beginning, the narrator will typically orient the listener to a different setting or situation. When you find such an orientation, treat that point as the start of a new story.

- **Habitual narrative**

- A habitual narrative is a story about repeated actions (daily routines or habits) or repeated events.
- As with stories, **consider the habitual narrative to begin from any introduction or overview of the habit or routine being discussed.**
- **As long as the narrator continues to comment on the same habit, routine, or repeated event, consider the habitual narrative to be ongoing.**
- If the narrator starts to talk about **a different habit or repeated event, or about a specific one-time event in the past**, judge that the habitual narrative ends immediately before that change.

- **Hypothetical narrative**

- A hypothetical narrative is a story about actions or events that did not actually occur. **As long as the narrator continues to comment on the same sequence of actions or events that did not occur, consider the hypothetical narrative to be ongoing.**

4.2 Criteria Based on the Role the Narrative Plays in the Interviewee's Answer

- In an interview conversation, the interviewee is expected to answer the interviewer's question. Beginning to tell a story as a direct answer to the interviewer's question would normally feel abrupt; in such cases it is easy to identify where the story begins because it starts suddenly.
- Typically, narratives are told **to supplement the interviewee's own answer** to the interviewer's question. The interviewee's answer to the interviewer's question is categorized as "Other," not as a story or narrative. After that direct answer, if **the interviewee launches into a longer statement that supplements the answer**, judge the start of that longer statement as the beginning of a story or narrative.

4.3 Criteria Based on Devices Used to Start a Narrative in Conversation

(In the following, "story/narrative" is abbreviated as "story.")

[The original document may list specific discourse devices used to launch a story, such as temporal markers or discourse markers. If provided, translate them here.]

4. Other Notes

- You do not need to assign labels to the interviewer's statements.
- At the end of the annotation task, check that there are no uncolored "S" or "E" marks remaining.
- Within one answer to an interviewer's question, it is possible for multiple narratives to be told.

5. References

The explanation and examples in section 4.3 are based on the following work:

- Hideya Kushida, Takeshi Hiramoto, Makoto Hayashi. *Introduction to Conversation Analysis* (Keisō Shobō, 2017).

